Egg Heist Arena: Game Design Document

Oct 4, 2026 · @Ali

1. Vision and pillars

Egg Heist Arena is a Roblox game where players raid dens for eggs, hatch original creatures and fight 3v3 arena battles. Every egg can be earned free, and Robux only buys time, convenience and style.

Audience: ages 9 to 16, mobile-first, playing with friends. Target maturity rating is Minimal or Mild so the game can qualify for Roblox Select. Cartoon stealing, no gore.

Five pillars

1. **Steal-and-hatch is the hook.** A player should see a raid, an egg and a reveal in the first 60 seconds.
2. **Battles give depth.** They are the reason to stay after week one and the thing clone games lack.
3. **The free path is complete.** No creature, mode or rank is locked behind payment.
4. **Money never buys power.** No paid raid speed, luck boosts or battle stats.
5. **Original IP.** Original creature names, silhouettes and UI. Nothing that reads as Pokémon.

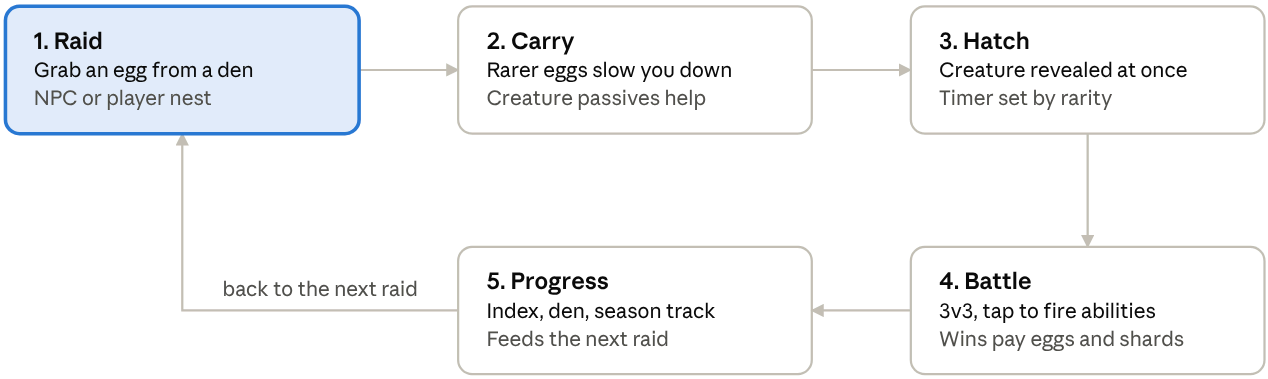
Four questions every feature must pass

- Can a free player get the same result, only slower?
- Does it change who wins a raid or a battle? If yes, cut it or make it earn-only.
- Is anything random bought with Robux? If yes, it follows the paid random item rules in section 9.
- Does it work for a player in a region where paid random items are restricted?

2. Core loop and session flow

One loop drives the whole game: raid a den, carry the egg home, hatch it, battle with the creatures you own, and use the rewards to raid again.

Every step of the core loop feeds the next raid



core loop · 5 steps, returns to the raid

Raiding is the hook for new players, and battles give the loop depth. Each step pays out into the next, so a short session always ends with progress.

A target 12-minute session (planning target, to verify in playtests)

1. **Minutes 0 to 1:** collect the free incubator egg and check timers.
2. **Minutes 1 to 5:** raid an NPC or player den and carry an egg home.
3. **Minutes 5 to 8:** hatch, reveal, and place creatures. Spend Sand or coins on upgrades.
4. **Minutes 8 to 12:** two or three battles for shards and a Battle Egg, then daily quests.

Sessions can be shorter. Players who only have 4 minutes can still collect an egg and fire a battle.

3. Creatures and rarity

The launch roster is 35 original creatures in six rarity tiers. Rarity changes how a creature looks and plays, not how strong it is: every creature sits within 5% of the same base stat total at the same level.

Roles. Each creature has one of four roles. A team with three different roles gets a small "Balanced" bonus, which keeps commons useful in competitive teams.

- **Striker:** high damage, low defense.
- **Guardian:** absorbs hits and protects teammates.
- **Support:** heals, buffs or speeds up ability charge.
- **Disruptor:** stuns, swaps positions or removes enemy buffs.

Roster by tier

Tier	Creatures	What makes it different	Example creatures (working names)
Common	10	One simple ability, clear silhouette	Pip Mallow (marsh mouse), Gutterfox, Crumb Crab, Dunebun
Uncommon	8	A two-step ability, such as strike then shield	Lantern Moth, Burrowl, Tinkerjay
Rare	6	Team-wide effect	Thornback Boar, Mistling, Cinder Skink
Epic	5	Rule-bending utility, such as revealing den traps or swapping places	Mirrorpaw, Echo Heron
Legendary	4	Signature ultimate with its own animation	Stormhide Elk, Hollow Wyrm
Mythic	2	Full cosmetic transformation plus a unique ultimate	Eclipse Fawn, The Gilded Magpie

Design rules

- **Stat band:** every creature's base stat total is 300, give or take 15 (5%). Commons may hold the best stat spread for a given role.
- **Variants:** every creature has Shiny and Golden variants earned through play, such as a Golden chance on the Index milestone eggs. Variants change looks only.
- **Seasonal creatures:** each 28-day season adds 4 to 6 new creatures to the free pass track and the egg pool. Seasonal creatures return in later seasons, so nothing is permanently missable.
- **No named IP:** names, silhouettes and move names are original. No red-and-white capture spheres, no type icons that mirror Pokémon, and no brainrot meme characters.
- **Art budget:** each creature needs an idle, attack, ability, hurt and reveal animation. Budget the roster early, since a 35-creature launch is the main art cost.

4. Eggs, odds and pity

Every egg reveals its creature the moment you obtain it, then incubates for a time set by that creature's rarity. Because the result is known before any timer skip is bought, a skip only speeds up a known outcome. All odds below are starting values to tune in playtests.

Egg types

- **Basic Egg:** free only. Earned from the incubator timer, quests and raids.
- **Battle Egg:** free only. Earned from wins, the streak and the season track.
- **Gem Egg:** bought with Robux. Phase 3 only, and a paid random item (see section 9).

Odds by tier. Each column sums to 100%. Within a tier, every creature has equal odds.

Tier	Basic Egg	Battle Egg	Gem Egg	Per creature in Gem Egg
Common (10)	62%	50%	40%	4.0%
Uncommon (8)	25%	30%	32%	4.0%
Rare (6)	10%	14%	18%	3.0%
Epic (5)	2.5%	4.5%	7.5%	1.5%
Legendary (4)	0.45%	1.3%	2.3%	0.575%
Mythic (2)	0.05%	0.2%	0.2%	0.1%

The free eggs are slightly worse than Gem Eggs on rare tiers, but Battle Eggs are close, and the pity counter below applies to all three. Show per-creature odds on every egg screen, free or paid, for trust.

Incubation times (set by the revealed creature)

Tier	Incubation
Common	5 min
Uncommon	15 min
Rare	1 hour
Epic	2 hours
Legendary	4 hours

Tier	Incubation
Mythic	8 hours

Pity counter. One shared counter, shown as "Legendary Guarantee: X/60", counts every egg opened, free or paid. At 60, the next egg is guaranteed Legendary or better and its odds panel shows "Legendary or better: 100%". Roblox classes pity systems as probability modifiers, so if the counter ever applies to Robux eggs it must be disclosed numerically and the odds display must update live.

Essence. Duplicates convert into Essence, a free, deterministic currency:

Duplicate tier	Essence
Common	5
Uncommon	10
Rare	25
Epic	60
Legendary	150
Mythic	400

400 Essence buys a chosen Legendary from the current pool. 1,200 Essence buys a chosen Mythic. This gives free players a guaranteed path and softens bad luck.

5. Free egg economy

An engaged free player should open 8 to 12 eggs a day and a casual one 4 to 6, so free players never feel they are watching paid players hatch more. Timers are a floor of free eggs, not the main gate: most eggs come from playing.

Sand is the free skip currency. 1 Sand skips 1 hour of incubation. Paid time skips use the same unit, so paying feels like "the same thing, faster" rather than a different game. Sand cannot be converted into eggs.

Source	Cadence	Reward	Notes
Incubator timer	Every 4 hours, stockpile cap 2	1 Basic Egg	Shorter than the 12-hour timer in comparable pack games, to suit short kid sessions
Playtime gifts	At 5, 15, 30 and 60 min per session	30 min Sand, Basic Egg, 1 hour Sand, Basic Egg	Cuts early drop-off
Raids	Per successful raid	The stolen egg itself	NPC dens respawn, so there is always a target
Battle wins	Every 3 wins, cap 5 per day	1 Battle Egg	Every battle pays shards toward the next egg
Daily quests	3 per day	1 Battle Egg and 2 hours Sand	Quests mix raid, battle and den tasks
Login streak	7 days; a missed day pauses it	Day 1 Basic Egg, day 3 Battle Egg, day 5 4 hours Sand, day 7 guaranteed Epic egg	Never resets to zero
Season free track	Every 28 days	An egg every 3 tiers	Eggs only, never raid power
Index milestones	At 10, 25 and 50 discoveries	Guaranteed Rare, Epic, Epic eggs	One-time rewards
Rewarded video	Up to 3 per day, ages 13+ only	1 hour Sand or 1 Basic Egg	No Robux involved. Ads are opt-in and exempt from the feed ban
Offline income	Up to 8 hours banked	Coins, not eggs	Keeps egg timers meaningful

Tuning targets (to verify in playtests)

- A new player gets 4 to 6 eggs in the first session.
- A free player reaches the Legendary pity guarantee (60 eggs) in about 7 to 10 days of regular play.
- Free players should reach every creature tier without paying. Check this with a spreadsheet model before launch.

6. Battle system

Battles are 3v3 tactical auto-battles: creatures attack on their own, and the player decides when to fire each creature's ability and when to swap. This works on a phone, tolerates lag, and produces readable 15-second clips.

How a battle works

1. Each side brings a team of three. Creatures attack automatically in speed order.
2. Every attack and hit fills that creature's **Charge** meter.
3. When Charge is full, the player taps to fire the ability. Firing at the right moment (to interrupt, to heal, to finish) is the skill.
4. Each player has one swap per battle to bring in a creature from a bench of one.
5. A battle lasts 60 to 120 seconds, with a hard cap of 3 minutes.

Modes

Mode	Levels	Purpose	Rewards
Practice vs NPC	True levels	Learn teams, earn first eggs	Shards, small coins
Den defense	True levels	Raids against a player's den fight their defending team, controlled by the AI	The egg, or a failed-raid shield
Ranked Arena	Normalized to level 50	Competitive ladder with seasonal resets every 28 days	Battle Eggs, ranked cosmetics
Wild Arena	True levels	Casual PvP for fun	Shards
Den Challenges	Normalized	Asynchronous: set a defense team, opponents attack on their own time, push notifications bring players back	Season points

Fairness rules

- Ranked normalizes every creature to the same level, so grinding cannot buy a win.
- Matchmaking uses rank first, then team power, so new players meet similar opponents.
- Rarity gives variety (unique abilities), not a stat edge. See section 3.
- No Robux purchase changes a creature's stats, ability charge rate or damage.

Build order. Ship the 3v3 auto-battle and ranked arena first. Add Den Challenges once Roblox's turn-based notification tools are released (announced for Studio beta in October 2026, with full release by the end of 2026; timelines may slip). A 2D Pocket Arena mode can come later using the announced 2D tools.

7. Raids and base protection

Raids steal eggs that are waiting in a den's nest, never hatched creatures and never anything bought with Robux. That removes the worst feeling in the genre, losing something you paid for, and keeps stealing away from paid-item trading rules.

What can be stolen

Item	Stealable?
Unhatched egg in a raidable nest slot	Yes
Hatched creature	No, bound to the account
Anything bought with Robux (eggs, creatures, skins)	No, bound to the account
Den coins	A share, capped per raid

Raid flow

1. Choose a den: an NPC den (respawns, always available) or a player den.
2. Reach the nest. Player dens fight your team against the owner's defending team, controlled by the AI.
3. Grab one egg. The egg's creature silhouette and rarity are visible, so the choice is a real decision.
4. Carry it home. Heavier, rarer eggs slow you down, and some creature passives help.
5. A caught raider drops the egg back into the nest.

Protecting players from griefing

- **New-player shield:** 48 hours with no player raids.
- **After-raid shield:** every den gets a free shield of about 30 minutes after being raided.
- **Daily cap:** a den can be successfully raided at most 5 times per day.
- **Vault slots:** 2 nest slots start un-raidable, growing to 3 through play. Cosmetic skins for them can be bought.

- **Revenge raids:** a player who was just raided gets a discounted revenge raid on the raider.
- **Shield breaks on attack:** a den's shield ends if its owner starts a raid, so shields protect offline or defensive players rather than enabling safe raiding.

Paid protection (convenience, capped)

A short paid shield is allowed, but total protection from all sources is capped at 2 hours per day for any player, free or paid. Shields do not stack and expire. Free players earn protection through quests, wins and login rewards, so paying only adds convenience.

Keeping raiders happy. NPC dens give raiders a steady target even when many players are shielded, so protection never starves the raid loop.

8. Monetization

Launch revenue comes from cosmetics and convenience, not from random packs. Everything below is a fixed outcome that never changes who wins a raid or a battle. Prices are starting points to test, at roughly 100 Robux per US dollar for the player.

Price list

Product	Type	Price (Robux)	Notes
Creature skins	Developer product	75 to 399	Looks only
Hatch animations	Developer product	149 to 299	Reveal clip fuel
Den themes	Developer product	199 to 399	Includes vault slot skins
Raid trails and emotes	Developer product	75 to 249	
2x Income	Game pass	399	Doubles coin income, not egg drops
Auto-collect	Game pass	199	
Extra incubator slot (up to 2)	Game pass	199 each	More eggs incubating at once, not more eggs

Product	Type	Price (Robux)	Notes
VIP	Game pass	299	Title, one den theme, emotes, +10% coins
1 hour of Sand	Developer product	15	Skips an hour of a revealed egg's timer
Instant hatch	Developer product	49	Any revealed egg with 4 hours or less left
30-minute shield	Developer product	39	Counts toward the 2-hour daily protection cap
Starter pack	Developer product	149	A specific Rare creature, a den skin and coins
Direct creature	Developer product	400 to 1,500	Specific creature, fixed price by tier. Mythics are earn-only
Season pass premium	Developer product	499	Cosmetics, a seasonal skin, coins and Sand. No eggs on the premium track
Gem Egg x1 or x10	Developer product	99 or 899	Phase 3 only. Paid random item, see section 9

Rules

- Never sell luck boosts, raid speed, stealth, den defense stats, battle stats or ability charge speed.
- Keep every paid bundle fixed-outcome. A bundle with even one random item becomes a paid random item as a whole.
- Sell anything near randomness as a developer product, not a game pass. Developer products can be hidden for restricted players. Game passes cannot.
- Hide Sand skips and instant hatch for restricted players until Roblox answers the open question in section 9.
- Roblox Plus subscribers get private servers free. Do not build revenue around Plus-specific payouts until Roblox's creator documentation confirms them.

What a Robux is worth to you. You keep about 70% of each sale, and Roblox's standard cash-out rate is $0.0038 per earned Robux, so each Robux spent is worth about $0.0027 to you. A game with 50,000 daily players spending 3 Robux each per day would earn roughly $12,000 a month at that rate. That is my planning estimate, not a Roblox benchmark.

9. Roblox compliance checklist

Anything bought with Robux, or with currency bought with Robux, that gives a random result is a paid random item under Roblox's May 2026 policy. Launch avoids paid random items entirely. Phase 3 adds Gem Eggs, which must pass every item below. Policy details come from Roblox's paid random items guidelines and its DevForum clarification thread. Rules changed several times in 2026, so recheck the Creator Hub before building.

Before Gem Eggs ship (Phase 3)

- [ ] Show every outcome and its exact percentage before purchase. Percentages sum to 100%, and a standalone "i" icon is not enough: use a visible Info or Details button.
- [ ] Disclose pity numerically and update displayed odds live while a modifier or guarantee applies.
- [ ] Make sure every possible outcome gives some benefit. No blank results.
- [ ] Call `ArePaidRandomItemsRestricted` for every player. If true, hide Gem Eggs and show the free path and direct-purchase alternatives instead.
- [ ] Call `IsPaidItemTradingAllowed`. Trading stays off at launch. If added later, trade only creatures that involved no Robux.
- [ ] Declare random items and PolicyService handling in the Maturity and Compliance Questionnaire, and test every flag in Studio's Player Emulator.
- [ ] Keep paid bundles fixed-outcome.
- [ ] Never sell luck boosts: Roblox staff confirmed luck game passes count as paid random items.

Always

- [ ] No in-game feeds of short videos, autoplay or infinite scroll with rewards for watching. Rewarded video ads are exempt.
- [ ] Rewarded ads only for players 13 and older, with the creator meeting Roblox's eligibility rules, and grant rewards through the official API.
- [ ] Answer the maturity questionnaire accurately. Keep stealing cartoonish and violence minimal so Select eligibility is possible.

- [ ] Use only approved external links.

Restricted markets (verify with the API, not hard-coded)

Market	Who is restricted	Source quality
UK	Users under 18	Official DevForum announcement
Australia	All users	Official DevForum announcement
Brazil	Under 18, and adults who haven't verified their age	Official Help Center
Belgium, Netherlands	Named as regulated, scope unpublished	Unverified, honor the API

The list changes over time. Roblox configures it centrally.

Open question: paid time skips

Roblox staff were asked whether a Robux skip on a random egg's timer is a paid random item. As of June 2026 they had not answered. This document's position is conservative:

- Skips only ever apply to eggs whose creature is already revealed.
- Skips are hidden for restricted players.
- Before launch, ask Roblox in writing and follow its answer.

10. Player journey and retention

Roblox's recommendation system now looks at a 28-day window and weighs first-play bounce rate (players who leave within the first minute or two), play-through rate (how many who see your icon press Play) and returning play. The plan below is built around those signals: win the first 60 seconds, then give a reason to return on days 2, 3, 7 and 28.

First 60 seconds

- Load the player straight into a short tutorial raid. No menus first.
- Reveal the first egg by second 45, with a rarity glow and a distinct sound.
- Make the icon and thumbnail show a real raid and a real creature, since misleading art raises bounce.

First week

Day	What the player does	Why they return
1	Tutorial raid, first egg reveal, first 3v3 battle with a starter trio, place a den, first raid on a bot den. Playtime gifts at 5, 15 and 30 minutes.	Incubator timer is running. 4 to 6 creatures by the end of the session.
2	Login streak day 2. Daily quests unlock. First real player raid, protected by the new-player shield. Index milestone at 10 discoveries gives a Rare egg.	Quests and the next Index milestone.
3	Ranked arena unlocks at 10 creatures. Battle Egg from the streak. Set a den defense team.	A first rank and a team to improve.
4 to 5	The new-player shield ends, so the first player raids on the den arrive. Revenge raid tutorial. Den upgrades. Season free track tier 5.	Being raided gives a reason to come back and respond.
6	A weekend event: 2 hours of boosted NPC dens with server-wide rare-egg announcements.	Social proof and a time window.
7	Streak day 7: guaranteed Epic egg. The pity counter is visibly around 40 to 50 out of 60. First Den Challenge once asynchronous notifications ship.	A big milestone and a near-term pity goal.

Weeks 2 to 4

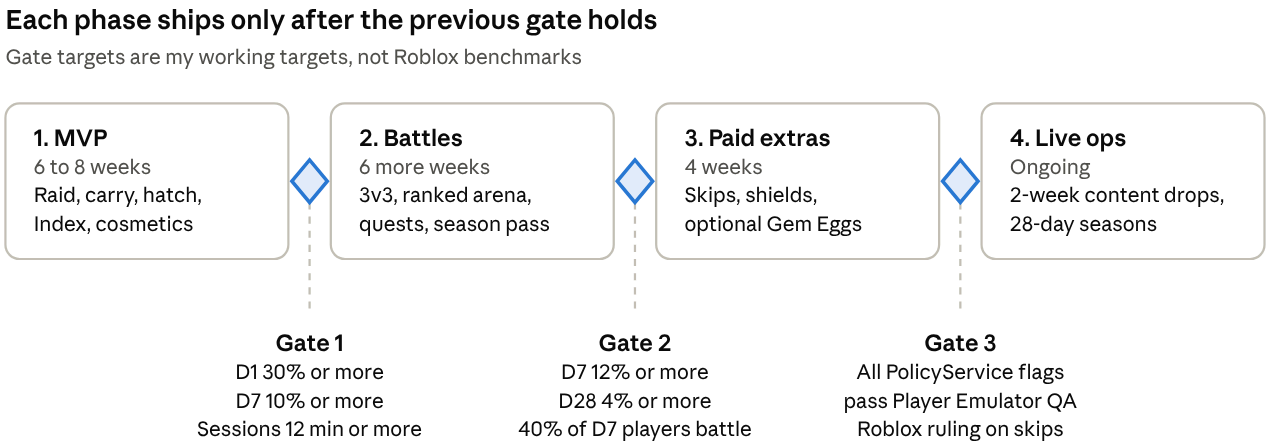
- **28-day season** matched to Roblox's window: a free and a premium pass track, ranked rewards at the end, and a seasonal creature.
- **Den wars:** weekly events with a leaderboard and shared rewards.
- **Co-op raids:** teams of two to four raid a hard NPC den together. Roblox treats playing together as a ranking signal.
- **Content drops every 2 weeks:** a new biome den or 4 to 6 creatures.
- **Asynchronous Den Challenges** with push notifications, once available.

Metrics to watch from day one

Metric	What to look for
First-play bounce	Under 60 seconds and 61 to 180 seconds buckets
Play-through rate	Test at least 3 thumbnails
D1, D7, D28 retention	Targets in section 11
Average session length	12 minutes or more
Eggs opened per day	Matches section 5 targets
Payer conversion and complaints	Watch for pay-to-win feedback

11. Roadmap and live ops

Build in four phases and move on only when the previous gate holds, so that a weak loop is fixed before more systems are added on top of it.



roadmap · 4 phases, 3 gates

Gate numbers are my working targets for a first launch, not Roblox benchmarks. Measure your own cohorts and adjust.

What revenue is live in each phase

Phase	Live	Held back
1. MVP	Cosmetics, 2x Income, Auto-collect, VIP, extra incubator slots	Skips, shields, direct creatures, packs
2. Battles	Adds direct creatures, starter pack, season pass	Skips, shields, Gem Eggs
3. Paid extras	Adds Sand skips, instant hatch, 30-minute shield, optional Gem Eggs	Nothing, with restricted-player hiding in place
4. Live ops	Same products, new seasonal cosmetics each season	None

Live-ops calendar

- **Every 2 weeks:** a new biome den or 4 to 6 creatures.
- **Every week:** a den-war event with a leaderboard.
- **Weekends:** a short boosted NPC-den window with server-wide rare-egg announcements.
- **Every 28 days:** a new season with a free and a premium track, ranked reset and a seasonal creature.
- **Holidays:** a themed event for each major holiday, starting with Halloween if timing allows.

12. Risks, open questions and first steps

The biggest risks are Roblox policy changes, building too much at once, and a short trend lifespan. All three are manageable with the phasing in section 11.

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Paid random item rules	Non-compliance can mean removal. Brazil already blocks minors from games that skip PolicyService	No Robux-random items at launch. Full odds UI, PolicyService and non-random paths in Phase 3
Unanswered skip ruling	Staff haven't said if paid timer skips count as paid random items	Reveal-then-incubate, hide skips for restricted players, ask Roblox in writing

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Engagement-gimmick policing	A top game was delisted in August 2026 over a reward-for-watching feed	No feeds, no autoplay, no watch-to-earn beyond opt-in rewarded ads
IP lookalikes	Pokémon-style names, balls or UI invite takedowns	Original creatures, names and UI from day one
Scope creep	Raids, battles and packs together is a lot for one team	Ship in phases, each gated by retention
Clone competition	Steal-and-hatch clones appear within weeks	The battle layer, original creatures and a 2-week content cadence
Short trend lifespan	A major 2026 sequel fell about 99% from its peak in four months	Plan a 28-day season and a content calendar before launch
Pay-to-win perception	Selling speed or protection drew backlash in a comparable game	Capped protection, no paid raid power, normalized ranked battles
Third-party data	Player counts and revenue figures come from trackers that disagree	Judge success by your own retention cohorts, not by player counts

First steps (next 2 weeks)

- [ ] Lock the 12 to 15 creature designs for the MVP and the visual style.
- [ ] Prototype the raid-and-carry loop on one NPC den and test the first 60 seconds.
- [ ] Build the egg reveal, incubator and Index.
- [ ] Set up retention and bounce analytics before the first playtest.
- [ ] Write to Roblox about paid time skips on revealed eggs.
- [ ] Draft three thumbnails and icons to test play-through rate.
- [ ] Model the free egg economy in a spreadsheet and confirm free players reach every tier.

Open questions

- Will Roblox allow paid time skips on revealed eggs without treating them as paid random items?

- Does the game qualify for Roblox Select, and what review does that need?
- What is the real payout behavior of Roblox Plus subscriptions for creators? Verify in the Creator Hub.
- How many creatures can the art budget support at launch?

Figures from Roblox's 2026 filings, press and trackers were gathered in earlier research in this conversation. Treat player counts and revenue estimates as approximate, and retention targets as my own working targets, not Roblox benchmarks.